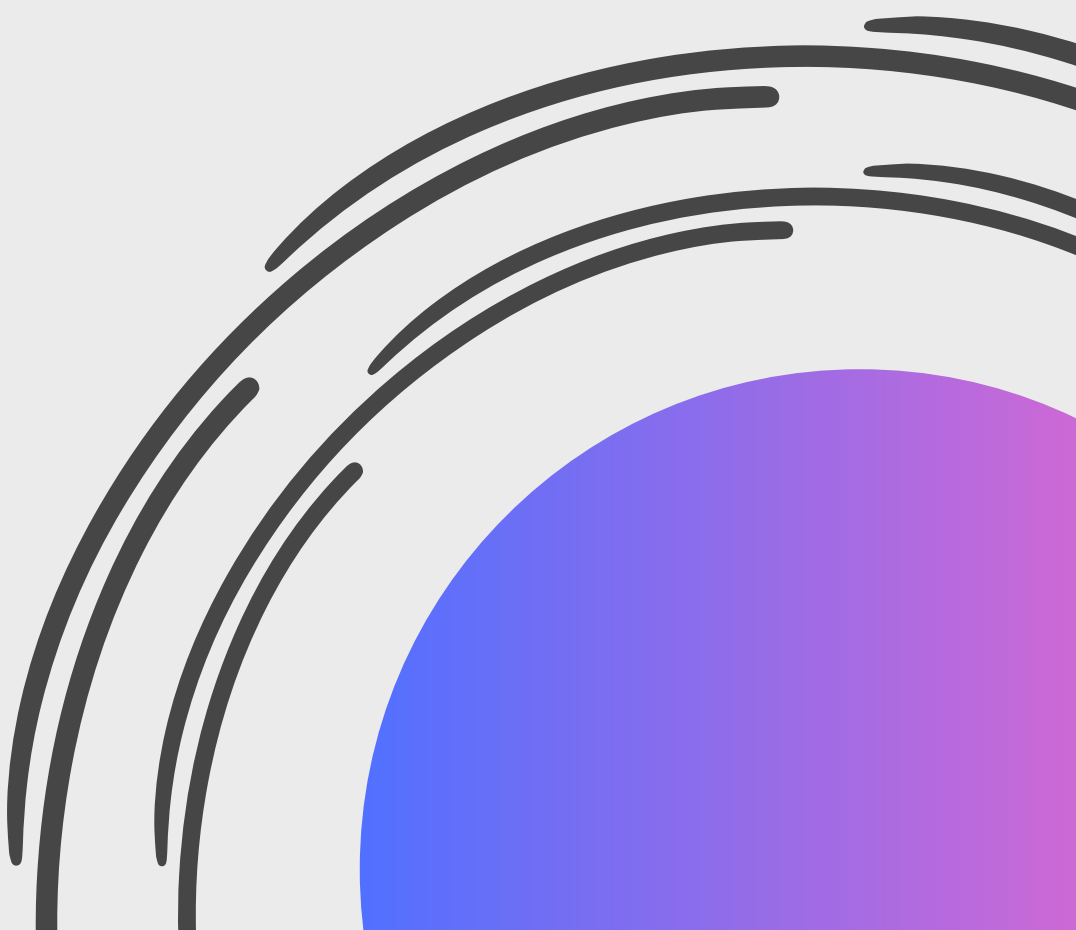




PHISHING & CYBER DECEPTION

By Mesirionye Esther





SECURITY AWARENESS MODULE

Mastering the art of digital defense. learn to recognize social engineering tactics, identify spoofed domains, and shield your perimeter from advanced AI phishing campaigns.





THE ESCALATING THREAT SCALE.

01

Cybercriminals are abandoning sloppy, poorly written templates. Generative AI tools are now deployed to craft hyper-personalized, linguistically flawless phishing campaigns at massive scale.

02

To elevate organizational exposure, we assess threat dynamics based on the strategic cybersecurity risk model: $\text{Risk} = \text{Threat} * \text{Vulnerability}$





ANATOMY OF A PHISHING EMAIL

01

DISPLAY NAME SPOOFING

Attackers modify the visible display name (eg, “CEO Office”) while hiding the actual compromised sender address behind a free or unrelated domain.

02

ARTIFICIAL URGENCY

Creating false deadline”(Account suspended in 2hours“) to bypass cognitive resistance and induce hasty, emotional decision-making.





SPOTTING FAKE WEBSITES & DOMAINS

01

HOMOGRAPH ATTACKS

Cybercriminals register domains using characters from different alphabets that look identical to genuine letters. Examl: Substituting the Latin letter “l” with the Cyrillic or numerical character “1” to register [microsoft.com](#) instead of the legitimate Microsoft address.

02

PADLOCK DECEPTION

A secure padlock icon (HTTPS) only indicates that the connection is encrypted, not that the site is trusted. Today, over 85% of malicious phishing websites utilizes valid SSL certificates to mimic standard commercial corporate portals.





THE PSYCHOLOGY OF SOCIAL ENGINEERING

- 1, **Impersonating Authority:** Attackers masquerade as high-ranking executives, legal firms, or law enforcement officers to demand immediate compliance from subordinates.
 - 2, **Leveraging Fear:** Threat of account termination, financial penalties, or legal action are used to cause panic and cloud analytical reasoning.
 - 3, **Exploiting Greed & Curiosity:** Lures featuring unsolicited bonuses, free corporate gifts, or confidential merger documents trigger the urge to investigate.
 - 4, **Exploiting Helpfulness:** Under the guise of an IT staff member needing remote assistance, attackers manipulate targets into relinquishing system access.
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ADVANCED THREATS: AI & QUISHING

The Rise of QR Code Phishing

Known as “[Quishing](#)”, this technique embeds malicious URLs inside QR codes, bypasses traditional secure email filters (which struggle to inspect graphics), and forces users onto insecure mobile devices.

Futhermore, AI-driven phishing engines generates tailored pretexts, using localized context and spotless grammar to evade human detection entirely.





CASE STUDY: GOOGLE & FACEBOOK

The \$100 Million Supplier Spoof

Between 2013 and 2015, cybercriminals executed a massive billing fraud scheme impersonating a trusted hardware supplier.

By leveraging matching fraudulent corporate invoices and cloned letterheads, they easily bypassed internal accounting verifications.





EXPERT INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVE

“Phishing has evolved from a simple IT challenge into a highly sophisticated human psychology vector.

Traditional ‘spot-the-typo’ training is no longer a viable defense against generative AI”

-DIRECTOR OF CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE





YOUR ANTI-PHISHING DEFENSE SHEILD

- **Enforce FIDO2 Hardware Keys:** Implement domain-bound physical authentication. FIDO2 standards actively block credential interception, even on proxied phishing portals.
 - **Mandate Out-of-Band Verification:** Never process unusual financial transactions, wire requests, or sensitive data transfers without calling the requestor directly using an established phone directory.
 - **Analyze Sender Headers:** Inspect the primary delivery route, checking SPF, DKIM, and DMARC alignment rather than trusting display names.
 - **Report Immediately:** Submit any suspicious mailings directly to your designated security operation portal using the native Phish-Report integration tool.
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INTERACTIVE QUIZ: RED FLAG EMAIL



SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Identify the Core
Vulnerability

From: service@paypal-
secure-portal.com

Subject: Urgent:
Unauthorized Login
detected!

We have temporarily
suspended your account
access. Please log in within
24 hours to secure your
funds: [http://paypal-
verlfication.com/security](http://paypal-verlfication.com/security)



WHICH OPTION POINTS TO FRAUD?

- A. The use of a secure PayPal logo in the header.
- B. The typo domain “verlfication.com” (with an “l” instead of “i”).
- C. The urgent delivery speed of the email payload.

INTERACTIVE QUIZ: QR CODE REQUEST



PHYSICAL SECURITY SCENARIO

The Lobby Poster Scan

You find an attractive physical poster near the breakroom. It states:

“Scan this QR code to download the new 2026 HR Benefits Companion App and instantly claim your corporate cafeteria voucher!”



WHAT IS YOUR IMMEDIATE RESPONSE?

- **A.** Scan the code to check if the destination is HTTPs secure.
- **B.** Call HR out-of-band to verify if this is an authorized app roll-out.
- **C.** Scan the code but refuse to submit corporate credentials.



SECURE YOUR PERIMETER

**Don't let hackers compromise your identity, Stay alert,
inspect, and verify.**





THANK YOU

